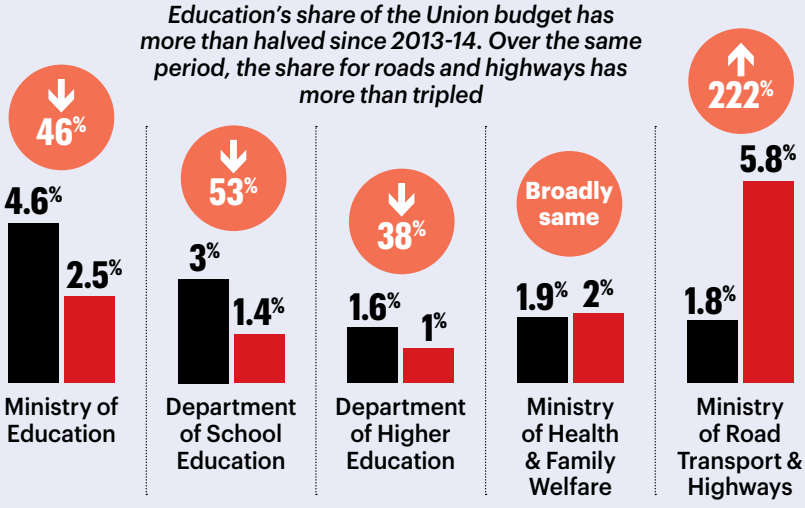


ANI

LOW ALLOCATION FOR EDUCATION

Education's share of the Union budget has more than halved since 2013-14. Over the same period, the share for roads and highways has more than tripled



Note: Figures are allocations as a percentage of the total Union budget, not absolute spending

THE POLITICAL FALLOUT

This is the first major mass agitation to test Modi's third-term government. What began as an online campaign became, in the space of two months, a contest over the government's ability to retain the confidence of India's young voters. It is still too early to conclude whether the CJP will damage the BJP the way the government's more enthusiastic supporters hope or its critics fear. Street numbers do not automatically translate into votes, and the party retains an unmatched organisational machine and Modi's personal appeal in his constituency. In its previous term, the Modi dispensation had faced the anti-CAA (Citizenship Amendment Act) and farmers' movements—but those could be painted as having a narrower, segmental base.

The CJP may represent a more difficult kind of challenge precisely because it cannot be filed away as neatly. For all their scale, past agitations could still be associated with identifiable constituencies—Sikh

INTERVIEW

"We want this to remain a leaderless movement"

SAURAV DAS, chief spokesperson of the Cockroach Janta Party, speaks to Anjum Sharma about the movement's direction, demands and the questions surrounding its credibility



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

ON DEMANDS

This is a youth movement, and young people have many kinds of anger. But we are absolutely clear that this is a movement against paper leaks. We have a detailed five-point policy demand charter for education reforms, including transparency and accountability. Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation will be the first step towards accountability

ON LEADERSHIP

We want this to remain a leaderless movement. Those who come here should return to their own areas, spread awareness and take up leadership roles there. We want a natural, grassroots movement

ON CRITICISM

People keep trying to label us in different ways, but nothing has stuck because we have come forward with clear, new and better ideas